Draft - expert review pending

This unit is complete and passes the platform’s automated checks, but no reviewer has read it yet. Treat its sources and claims with care.

Unit 1 teacher notes

Sequencing note

The three topics follow the logic of a single lesson. Topic 1.1 asks what words mean in context and how grammar creates meaning. Topic 1.2 asks how words are built and how sentences are structured. Topic 1.3 asks how the sounds of English carry meaning. Each topic builds on the previous one, so teach them in order across the four weeks the content-spec allows.

Common misconceptions to probe

1. **"Vocabulary means memorising long word lists."** This is the most persistent one. Probe it by asking: "If you know the meaning of 'run' but not its collocations, can you use it correctly?" Trainees who equate vocabulary with word lists will find the register and collocation sections counter-intuitive.

2. **"Grammar rules are fixed and universal."** Probe it by asking: "If grammar is fixed, why do British and American English differ in their use of the present perfect?" The goal is to shift from rule-memorisation to understanding how grammar creates meaning.

3. **"Pronunciation does not matter as long as people understand you."** Probe it by asking: "If someone says 'I need a pin' and you hear 'I need a fin', has communication succeeded?" The goal is to make the case that clarity matters, not accent.

Managing the activities

Topic 1.1 - Analyse a text for vocabulary and grammar (25 minutes, pairs). The trap is that trainees identify words without explaining their context-dependence. Push them back: "What does this word mean in THIS context, and how do you know?" Circulate and listen for explanations that go beyond dictionary definitions.

Topic 1.2 - Analyse word formation and sentence structure (25 minutes, groups of three). The trap is that trainees classify sentences by length rather than by clause structure. Remind them: "A long sentence can be simple; a short sentence can be complex. Count the clauses, not the words."

Topic 1.3 - Minimal pairs practice (15 minutes, pairs). This is a quick, active exercise. The key teaching move is the debrief: ask which pairs were hardest and why. The answer will almost always be the pairs involving sounds that do not exist in Urdu.

Practical work and practicum links

Each topic carries a "Try this at your practicum school" task. The unit works best when the tutor sets these up explicitly before trainees leave for practicum and debriefs them when trainees return.

- **Topic 1.1 practicum task** (collect pupil writing samples) produces a small data set. Use it to open Topic 1.2: ask trainees which vocabulary issues were most common, and use their examples to motivate the word-formation section.
- **Topic 1.2 practicum task** (analyse textbook material) produces a comparison. Use it to make the point that textbooks vary in the sentence structures they present, and that pupils need exposure to all four.
- **Topic 1.3 practicum task** (record a teacher reading) produces a pronunciation analysis. Use it to make the point that even fluent teachers have pronunciation features that may confuse pupils.

A note on the figures

The unit carries six figures: two concept-map figures (fig-U1-1, fig-U1-5), two diagram figures (fig-U1-2, fig-U1-3), and two table figures (fig-U1-4, fig-U1-6). The tables are the ones trainees most often try to read as prose. Before you project any of them, ask trainees to read the column headers first and say what the table is comparing.

Assessment note

The 10/10/5 bank is designed to be used in two passes: the MCQs and RRQs as formative checks at the end of Topics 1.2 and 1.3, and the ERQs as a summative task at the end of the unit. ERQ 5 (the integrative item) is the one that most reliably separates trainees who have understood the unit from those who have memorised its definitions. If you use only one ERQ, use that one.

Tip: select any text on this page first to comment on that specific passage - or leave nothing selected for general feedback.

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